

Representation & Copy Standard (RCS™)

OOF™ Origin Open Foundation™

Independent Methodological Authority

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Origin Declaration Standard (ODS™) · Audit in Real Time™

Authority: OOF™ Origin Open Foundation™

Protection: MIP™ — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (UCL™)

A. Standard Abstract

The Representation & Copy Standard (RCS™) defines the structural distinction between an original asset, its copies, and its representations across physical, digital, and virtual environments.

The standard establishes a clear framework for identifying what a work is, how it exists, and under what conditions it may be reproduced, represented, exhibited, or referenced.

RCS™ does not replace ownership law, copyright law, or institutional policy. RCS™ defines structural classification.

B. Canonical Definition

Representation & Copy Standard (RCS™) is a methodology for classifying original assets, copies, and representations according to their origin, form, relationship to the source, and declared mode of existence.

RCS™ distinguishes between:

- what constitutes an original
- what constitutes a copy
- what constitutes a representation
- how each form may exist without confusion of status

Origin defines what it is.

Representation defines how it exists.

C. Base

An asset may exist in more than one form,
but not in more than one origin state.

- A copy is not an origin.
- A representation is not the original.
- A digital form does not automatically invalidate authenticity.
- A physical form does not automatically guarantee originality.

Clear classification is necessary whenever value, authorship, exhibition, insurance, licensing, or public trust depends on the declared status of a work.

D. Core Principle

A work must be classified according to its true structural state.

- No copy may be presented as an original.
- No representation may be treated as identical to source unless explicitly defined.
- No asset may derive legitimacy from ambiguity.

Core Structural Categories

RCS™ recognizes the following core states:

- Original Asset
- Physical Copy
- Digital Copy
- Digital Original
- Virtual Representation
- Replica

Additional rights, authorization, and exhibition conditions may apply, but they do not alter the underlying state of the asset.

Scope

This standard applies to:

- artworks
 - museum objects
 - gallery editions
 - digital cultural assets
 - archival reproductions
 - virtual exhibitions
 - scanned or photographed works
 - digitally originated works
 - licensed reproductions
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Structural Rule

Every asset must be classified according to:

- origin state
 - form of existence
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- relationship to the source
- declared representation status

If these elements are not clearly declared,
the asset remains structurally ambiguous.

Methodology

- identify the source asset
 - determine whether the asset is original, copy, or representation
 - determine whether the form is physical, digital, or virtual
 - define the relationship between the asset and the source
 - declare the status of the asset
 - assign any additional rights or exhibition conditions separately
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Use Context

- museums and collections
 - galleries and edition structures
 - insurance and valuation contexts
 - virtual exhibitions
 - cultural archiving
 - licensed display systems
 - digital heritage systems
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Positioning

Not every visible form is an original.

Not every copy is illegitimate.

Not every digital form is secondary.

Classification creates clarity.

Canonical Closing Statement

When the status of a work is unclear, trust collapses.

Representation requires classification
before value can be protected.

Modules

→ Digital Copy Module (DCM™)

→ Digital Original Module (DOM™)

→ Edition Module (EDM™)

→ Exhibition Mode Module (EMM™)

- Replica Module (RPM)
- Virtual Representation Module (VRM™)
- Original Asset Module (OAM™)
- Physical Copy Module (PCM™)
- Rights & Authorization Module (RAM™)

Related Documents

- About the Representation & Copy Standard (RCS™)

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Canonical Source

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